

Life story

Our bodies change and develop over the course of a lifetime. From birth to old age, we go through several distinct stages of life. During infancy and continuing through childhood, we grow rapidly and pick up life skills. In our teenage years we mature into adults. As grown women and men we may have children of our own. Finally, in old age, our bodies start to wear out.

WOW!

Frenchwoman
Jeanne Calment had the
longest-known lifespan.
She was 122 years and
164 days old when she
died in 1997.

INFANCY

In the first year of life, a baby is completely dependent on his or her parents. However, babies grow rapidly and gradually gain more control of their muscles, moving from sitting to crawling, standing up, and then walking. Infants develop a basic understanding of language and interact with their parents using eye contact, sounds, and facial expressions.

CHILDHOOD

Between the ages of one and 10, children grow and change proportion. As limbs grow longer, the head looks smaller compared to the body. The brain develops rapidly and makes lots of new connections, enabling children to acquire new skills, including speaking, reading, and writing. They also learn to walk, run, and ride a bike.

